

Spiritual Gems and Bible Reading - August 10-16, 2026

Spiritual Gems and Bible Reading — Week of August 10-16, 2026

Bible reading: Jeremiah 24-25 | Assigned reading: Jeremiah 24:1-10 “What spiritual gems from this week’s Bible reading would you like to share?”

Includes a prepared answer for the official Spiritual Gems question, 15 comment options, 2 research/insight angles, and Bible reading delivery notes. The comment options avoid the Treasures verses (Jer 24:1, 2, 5-10) and the official Spiritual Gems question (Jer 25:8, 9, 12).

Official Spiritual Gems Question

Jeremiah 25:8, 9, 12

Question: Why did Jehovah punish Babylon when it acted as his “servant” to execute judgment on his people?

Answer option (~30 sec): Babylon was Jehovah’s “servant” only in the sense that Jehovah allowed it to execute judgment on Judah. But Babylon did not act out of love for Jehovah or respect for his justice. It acted proudly and cruelly, and it opposed Jehovah’s people and sovereignty. So after Jehovah used Babylon to discipline his people, he held Babylon accountable for its own wickedness.

Comment Options

15 comment options + 2 research/insight angles (highlighted in blue in the HTML/PDF). Each comment is about 20-30 seconds spoken.

#	Verse	What I take away
1	Jer 24:3	Jehovah asks questions that help his servants see clearly
2	Jer 24:4	Jehovah explains the meaning of what he shows us
3	Jer 24:6	Jehovah can watch over disciplined ones “for their good”

#	Verse	What I take away
4	Jer 24:7	Real return starts with the heart
5	Jer 25:3	Jehovah is patient over many years, not only many days
6	Jer 25:4	Jehovah sends warnings repeatedly because lives matter
7	Jer 25:5	Jehovah's warnings often include a way to keep living
8	Jer 25:6	False worship hurts Jehovah because it hurts his people
9	Jer 25:7	Refusing to listen can make a person harm himself
10	Jer 25:11	Jehovah's discipline has a measured limit
11	Jer 25:14	No empire is too powerful for Jehovah to judge
12	Jer 25:15	Jehovah's judgment is not emotional impulse; it is deliberate justice
13	Jer 25:17	Jeremiah accepted a difficult assignment without choosing the audience
14	Jer 25:29	Bearing Jehovah's name brings responsibility, not immunity
15	Jer 25:31	Jehovah has a legal case with the nations
R1	Jer 25:3, 4	 <i>Jeremiah book</i> : Jehovah "kept sending" his servants, showing persistent mercy
R2	Jer 25:11, 12	 <i>Insight book</i> : the 70 years show Jehovah's timing is exact

1 • Jeremiah 24:3

"What do you see?"

Jer 24:3 shows Jehovah asking Jeremiah what he saw. Jehovah already knew the answer, but the question helped Jeremiah focus on the lesson. That teaches me something about Jehovah's way of teaching. He does not merely lecture. He helps his servants observe, think, and reach the point. In the ministry, good questions can help people see truth for themselves.

2 • Jeremiah 24:4

Jehovah's word came

After Jeremiah saw the two baskets of figs, Jer 24:4 says Jehovah's word came to him. The vision was not left vague. Jehovah explained it. That reassures me that Jehovah does not expect his servants to guess his thinking. Through his Word and organization, he gives enough explanation for us to know what course is wise and safe.

3 • Jeremiah 24:6

"For their good"

Jer 24:6 is touching because Jehovah says he would keep his eyes on the exiles "for their good." Their exile was discipline, but Jehovah's motive was not rejection. He still intended to build them up. This helps me see correction differently. When Jehovah allows discipline, his goal is not to crush sincere ones but to help them recover and become useful again.

4 • Jeremiah 24:7

"A heart to know me"

Jer 24:7 says Jehovah would give repentant ones "a heart to know" him. Their return was not just geographic; it had to become inward. They needed a new heart. That reminds me that spiritual recovery is deeper than resuming activity or changing location. Jehovah wants the heart back. He helps us know him personally and return to him completely.

5 • Jeremiah 25:3

23 years

Jer 25:3 mentions that Jeremiah had been speaking Jehovah's word for 23 years. That number makes Jehovah's patience feel real. He did not warn once and then act. He kept giving the people time to respond. In our ministry, we imitate that patient spirit. Some people need repeated opportunities before a Bible truth finally reaches the heart.

6 • Jeremiah 25:4

Again and again

Jer 25:4 says Jehovah kept sending his servants the prophets "again and again." That phrase reveals Jehovah's persistence. His warnings were not cold announcements of doom; they were repeated efforts to rescue. It helps me stay persistent in the ministry. We return, call again, and keep offering help because Jehovah's own pattern is patient and repeated mercy.

7 • Jeremiah 25:5

"Turn back"

Jer 25:5 shows the loving purpose behind Jehovah's warning. He told the people to turn back from their bad way so they could keep living in the land. Jehovah was not looking for a reason to punish them. He was showing them how to avoid disaster. That is how I want to view counsel: not as restriction, but as a route back to life.

8 • Jeremiah 25:6

“Do not follow other gods”

Jer 25:6 connects false worship with provoking Jehovah and bringing harm on themselves. That helps me see Jehovah’s jealousy as protective, not selfish. False gods cannot love, guide, forgive, or save. When Jehovah warns against them, he is protecting people from empty worship that damages them. In the ministry, we offer people the living God, not a lifeless substitute.

9 • Jeremiah 25:7

“To your own harm”

Jer 25:7 says the people refused to listen and acted “to their own harm.” Jehovah was not the one damaged by their disobedience. They were. That is a powerful way to explain Bible standards. Jehovah’s commands are not about control. He knows what harms humans, and when people ignore him, they often wound themselves first.

10 • Jeremiah 25:11

70 years

Jer 25:11 shows that even Jehovah’s discipline had a measured limit: 70 years. That tells me Jehovah’s correction is never uncontrolled. He knows the purpose, the length, and the outcome. When we go through discipline or hardship, we may not know every detail, but Jehovah does. His timing is exact, and his discipline is governed by wisdom.

11 • Jeremiah 25:14

“Great kings will make slaves of them”

Jer 25:14 looks beyond Babylon’s temporary power. Babylon would conquer others, but later others would conquer Babylon. This reminds me that no human empire is beyond Jehovah’s reach. World powers may look permanent in their own day, but Jehovah sees their beginning and end. That gives us calm confidence as we preach about God’s Kingdom.

12 • Jeremiah 25:15

“Take this cup”

In Jer 25:15, Jehovah gives Jeremiah the image of a cup of wrath that nations would have to drink. The picture is sobering, but it also shows that Jehovah’s judgment is deliberate and measured. He does not react impulsively. He gives warnings, weighs conduct, and judges with perfect knowledge. That strengthens my trust in his justice.

13 • Jeremiah 25:17

“I took the cup”

Jer 25:17 says Jeremiah took the cup from Jehovah’s hand and made the nations drink. Of course, this was prophetic, but it shows Jeremiah accepting a hard assignment. He did not choose only easy audiences. In our ministry, we also meet different responses. Jeremiah helps me remember that faithfulness means delivering Jehovah’s message, not selecting only comfortable territory.

14 • Jeremiah 25:29

“The city that bears my name”

Jer 25:29 says judgment began with the city that bore Jehovah’s name. That is sobering. Having Jehovah’s name attached to us is a privilege, but it also brings responsibility. We never want to think that identity alone protects us while conduct does not matter. Bearing Jehovah’s name should move us to live in a way that honors him.

15 • Jeremiah 25:31

“A legal case”

Jer 25:31 says Jehovah has a legal case with the nations. That phrase helps me appreciate that his judgment is based on justice, not mere power. He has evidence. He has standards. He has the right to hold nations accountable. In the ministry, this supports our confidence that Jehovah’s future judgment will be righteous and necessary.



R1 • Jeremiah 25:3, 4 — *Jeremiah book connection*

Persistent warnings

The *Jeremiah* book emphasizes how Jehovah repeatedly sent prophets to warn his people. Jeremiah 25:3, 4 lets us feel that persistence: 23 years of Jeremiah’s preaching, along with other prophets being sent again and again. Jehovah’s patience was not passive. It took action. That teaches me to view repeated reminders as evidence of Jehovah’s mercy, not irritation.



70 years

The *Insight* material on Bible chronology helps us appreciate the exactness of the 70 years connected with Babylon. Jeremiah 25:11, 12 shows that Jehovah not only foretold the discipline but also its limit and Babylon's later punishment. That strengthens my confidence that Jehovah's timetable is never vague. When he sets a time, he can fulfill it precisely.

Bible Reading Assignment — Jeremiah 24:1-10

Study 5: Accurate Reading

Main objective

Read exactly what is written, with clear pronunciation and careful attention to punctuation. The passage has a simple structure: Jehovah shows Jeremiah two baskets of figs, explains what the good figs represent, then explains what the bad figs represent.

Suggested reading flow

Verses	Thought	Reading approach
1-3	Jeremiah sees two baskets of figs	Read calmly and clearly; make the contrast between “very good figs” and “very bad figs” easy to hear
4-7	The good figs represent repentant exiles	Use a warm, hopeful tone; stress “for their good,” “build them up,” and “a heart to know me”
8-10	The bad figs represent unrepentant ones	Shift to a sober tone; keep the pace steady and do not overdramatize the judgment language

Practice reminders

- Pronounce the names clearly: Jeremiah, Jeconiah, Nebuchadnezzar, Zedekiah.
- Do not rush the lists in verses 1 and 8.

- Pause slightly before the contrast in verse 3: “very good figs” / “very bad figs.”
- Let punctuation guide the reading so the long sentences remain understandable.
- Aim for dignified accuracy rather than dramatic performance.

Verified source pages

- English meeting schedule: <https://www.jw.org/en/library/jw-meeting-workbook/july-august-2026-mwb/Life-and-Ministry-Meeting-Schedule-for-August-10-16-2026/>
- Tagalog meeting schedule: <https://www.jw.org/tl/library/jw-workbook-para-sa-pulong/hulyo-agosto-2026-mwb/Iskedyul-ng-Pulong-Para-sa-Buhay-at-Ministryo-Para-sa-Agosto-10-16-2026/>
- English book study: <https://www.jw.org/en/library/books/walk-courageously-with-god/patriarchs-to-time-of-judges/sarah-refused-to-look-back/>